

Prebiotics and Probiotics

Foods for a Healthy Gut

Gut health depends on a balanced community of beneficial bacteria. Prebiotics are types of fiber that feed these bacteria. Probiotics are live bacteria found in fermented foods. Including both in the diet supports a healthy digestive system.

Understanding Prebiotics and Probiotics

Prebiotics are non-digestible fibers that reach the colon intact and serve as food for beneficial bacteria. Probiotics are live bacteria in fermented foods that add to the existing gut microbiota. Together, they help maintain a balanced gut environment.

Food Sources

Prebiotic-rich foods include garlic, onions, leeks, bananas, oats, apples, and asparagus. Probiotic-rich foods include curd, kefir, sauerkraut, kimchi, and traditional fermented rice or batters like idli and dosa batter.

Suggested Items:

- Curd (yogurt) - widely available probiotic source
- Idli and dosa batter (fermented) - traditional probiotic
- Garlic and onions - rich prebiotic fiber
- Bananas - contain inulin, a prebiotic
- Oats - beta-glucan supports beneficial bacteria
- Sauerkraut and kimchi - fermented cabbage with live cultures

Food	Type	Benefit
Curd	Probiotic	Live cultures
Idli batter	Probiotic	Lactic acid bacteria
Garlic	Prebiotic	Inulin
Banana	Prebiotic	Inulin, pectin
Oats	Prebiotic	Beta-glucan

Conclusion

Eating a mix of prebiotic and probiotic foods supports a balanced gut microbiome. Some people find fermented foods easier to digest when introduced gradually.